Alejandro Velazquez

Stevenage, United Kingdom · British citizen · aleuxuk@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/velazquezalejandro

PORTFOLIO ale-portfolio.github.io/ux

SUMMARY

Product design leader with 20+ years building and scaling fintech, open banking, payments, SaaS and platform products across Europe and Latin America. Joined Yapily as the company's first Product UX Designer, built the design function and led a team of two, owning product design across the platform.

Experienced partnering with executive leadership, product and engineering teams to deliver customer-centred solutions in highly regulated environments. Specialised in API-first platforms, developer experience, payment infrastructure and enterprise SaaS.

EXPERIENCE

Founding Designer (Contract)

Sep 2026 – Present

Almanac — London — trade credit decisions for UK suppliers

- Founding designer on a pre-launch platform that helps UK suppliers decide whether to extend trade credit to a business customer, and on what terms. Each customer has one credit file combining the application, Companies House, credit bureau, VAT and open banking checks, an AI-drafted analysis and a named reviewer’s decision, recorded with its evidence.
- Designed the supplier portal, the customer application and portal, referee links, sign-in and onboarding, platform administration and the marketing website. Maintain an interactive prototype of 90 screens and 537 states, kept in sync with production.
- Launching in January 2027 in partnership with a major credit bureau.

Lead Product Designer & Design Manager

Jan 2020 – Sep 2026

Yapily — London — open banking infrastructure across the UK and Europe

- Joined as the company's first Product UX Designer and built the design function. Managed a team of two product designers, owning hiring, onboarding and performance reviews; seven designers managed across six years as the team changed shape.
- Led the strategy, design and launch of Hosted Pages, the white-label bank-connection and consent flow spanning over 2,000 banks across 19 countries, reducing customer integration effort from four to six months — sometimes over a year for complex cases — to around two weeks. Used by 200 companies, drawn from a customer base that includes Google, Adyen, Intuit, Ant Financial and Revolut.
- End-to-end conversion rose from around 20% at the 2023 beta to 65–75% by 2026, varying by use case and market — moved incrementally over three years by UX, frontend and backend together, alongside expanding bank coverage. Design's share was concentrated in bank discoverability: display names matched to what people call their bank, search alias gaps found in testing and passed to engineering, and the grouping and shortcut redesign of bank selection.
- Built the research practice with no dedicated research function: over 200 customer interviews at a sustained monthly cadence since 2020, a 2023–2026 programme of moderated and unmoderated end-user testing across usability, market coverage and live bank integrations, with real people connecting real accounts, commissioned usability, accessibility and competitor benchmarking studies through Testbirds and Applause, and guerrilla testing for early iterations. Set up a bi-weekly feedback forum and shared prioritisation board with product, customer success, support and engineering, and restructured the documentation information architecture through card sorting, testing findability before and after.
- Defined the experimentation pipeline with product and built it in-house with engineering, enabling live A/B testing against production traffic. Screen-level results include improved conversion on bank selection, and reduced drop-off and user error on the QR code handoff.
- Led the accessibility work on Hosted Pages. A commissioned audit found contrast failures and screen readers announcing raw SVG markup because alternative text was implemented incorrectly, leaving the flow unnavigable by screen reader; we postponed a release to fix both rather than ship and correct later. I documented the findings for the frontend team to work from. A separate unmoderated study of 21 testers in Germany, including participants with disabilities, found 62% preferred the redesigned flow, rising to 78% among testers with disabilities.
- Mapped the end-to-end customer journey across sales, customer success, technical services, support and operations, and led the information architecture for the Console redesign that followed. Ran a two-day hackathon with engineering, product and implementation, role-playing as an outside consultancy using only what a real customer can access, to surface onboarding blockers. The Console was in beta at the point I left; the Hosted Pages configurator shipped in full, giving customers self-serve control over every screen — previously a support ticket and an engineer per request.
- Wrote Yapily's open banking UX guidance for customers building their own experiences — covering end-to-end flows, consent screens, consent dashboards, return experiences, re-consent journeys and checkouts — delivered as documentation plus interactive demos.
- Set the vision and problem framing for demo.yapily.com, led its design and maintained it with my team — an indexed library of live demo journeys running real end-to-end flows against mock and live banks, used in implementation, sales and RFI conversations.
- Built three design systems from scratch for different consumers — internal tools, the white-label customer-facing foundation, and the marketing site — documented in Storybook and Figma on a shared token layer, with around 38 engineers and 4 designers building against them. Built the contribution and approval governance jointly with the frontend lead, and handed each established system to a designer on the team.
- Led design across six rebrands and the yapily.com homepage redesign with marketing and two external agencies, and led the team producing brand and sales collateral behind go-to-market.
- Partnered with executive leadership on product strategy, prioritisation and platform vision, and supported the compliance team on FCA presentations.
- Worked with designers and product managers at Google over two years as they built open banking products on Yapily. Led the migration of the design systems into AI tooling as part of a company-wide AI transformation.

Lead Product Designer

Dec 2018 – Dec 2019

HeadBox — London — enterprise event technology and SaaS platform

- Led product design through a leadership transition with no reliable way to measure product performance. Three rounds of research with 45 customers and non-customers, alongside observation, support and message analysis, refocused the team on the enquiry-to-booking funnel, where only 20% of enquiries received a host proposal.
- Shipped the Enquiry Hub as a deliberately small experiment — London only, capped at £10k — which showed the platform connected hosts and guests well but converted poorly, and led to the pivot from marketplace to SaaS lead generation.
- Designed and launched the company's first SaaS product for venue partners, generating £150,228 ARR from 117 customers within three months — four times the prior model's performance.
- Established the design system, governance framework and research practice used across the organisation.

Product Design Lead & Co-founder

Nov 2016 – Dec 2018

Su4erheroes (THEVAULT15 Ltd) — London — product design consultancy

- Co-founded a product design consultancy with former Payfriendz colleagues; company director from January 2018. Led design across client engagements in payments, marketplaces and health.
- **Docomo Digital (principal client)** — Senior Product Designer on NOMO, a marketplace payments platform supporting merchant onboarding, compliance, wallet management and automated vendor payouts through APIs. Designed payment, payout and reconciliation experiences for international marketplaces and sharing-economy platforms, simplifying workflows involving settlements, merchant management and international payments. Worked with product, service design and engineering teams across Europe and Asia.
- **Caremoni / My Support Broker (client)** — designed a payment and reconciliation platform for a social enterprise managing NHS personal health budgets, where allocation, payment and reconciliation were entirely manual and error-prone. Interviewed every party in the chain — operators, independent carers, care agencies and people receiving care — then ran a concierge pilot with a plain front end and payments still processed by hand, which corrected a wrong assumption about digital confidence and reframed the problem as admin burden. Designed an operator dashboard for budget allocation, spend monitoring and NHS reporting, plus an app for carers and customers to request and authorise payments. The product reached MVP and ran as a pilot with a subset of customers.

Lead Product Designer

Oct 2013 – Nov 2016

Payfriendz — London — digital wallet and peer-to-peer payments platform

- Directed mobile and web experience design across multiple product releases with two designers and fifteen engineers, working closely with founders to define product strategy and platform evolution. Built the UI component system and mentored support staff into research roles.
- Designed user journeys supporting digital wallets, peer-to-peer payments and emerging embedded finance capabilities, and introduced user research and usability testing practices that informed prioritisation.
- Result: £5M+ transferred by 150,000+ users; ranked #1–3 in the Apple App Store finance category.

Product Designer (Contract)

Jan 2013 – Oct 2013

Payango — Berlin — worked remotely from Philadelphia, USA

- Designed user experiences for prepaid card, digital banking and payment products.

Designer

Aug 2011 – Nov 2012

Andimol — Argentina, then remote from the USA

- Interaction design and UX/UI consultancy for Latin American firms.

Design Analyst

Sep 2008 – Aug 2011

Globant — Argentina

- Designed enterprise products and digital experiences for organisations including Google, JP Morgan, PwC, Coca-Cola, Telefónica and Travelocity, working within multidisciplinary product and engineering teams.

Early Career

2005 – 2008

Sysnet Mexico, Datasygma & Independent — Argentina

- Motion design for Nokia HQ information screens (Sysnet, Mexico — worked remotely from Argentina); freelance and web design roles (Datasygma, independent).

EDUCATION

Escuela Da Vinci — Multimedia & Web Design

Universidad de Buenos Aires — Human Resources (Relaciones Laborales)

SKILLS

Design Leadership · Product Strategy · Product Discovery · Open Banking · Payments · Platform & API-first Products · Developer Experience · Enterprise SaaS · Design Systems · Design Operations · User Research · Experimentation & A/B Testing · Accessibility · Stakeholder Management · HTML, CSS & JavaScript